

TASK 5

PART A: Case Study

Topic: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

UPI fraud is one of the most common cybercrimes in India, where attackers trick users into sharing sensitive information or approving fake payment requests. In a typical case, a student receives a message or phone call claiming to be from a bank official or a trusted service provider. The attacker may ask the user to click on a link or request them to enter their UPI PIN or OTP for verification.

Once the victim shares these details or approves a payment request, money is instantly transferred from their account to the fraudster's account. In some cases, attackers send fake "receive money" requests, and when the user approves it, money gets deducted instead of received.

Students and elderly people are often targeted because they may not be fully aware of such scams. The consequences include financial loss, stress, and difficulty in recovering the stolen money.

This case highlights the importance of being cautious while making online transactions and never sharing confidential information. Awareness and basic digital safety practices can help prevent such cybercrimes.

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

1. Never share your OTP or UPI PIN with anyone
2. Always verify payment requests before approving
3. Do not click on unknown or suspicious links
4. Use strong and unique passwords
5. Enable two-factor authentication on accounts
6. Install apps only from trusted sources
7. Keep your apps and devices updated regularly
8. Avoid using public Wi-Fi for financial transactions

UPI Safety Tips:

9. Always check the receiver's name before sending money
10. Never approve unknown "collect request" payments

Report Cybercrime:

Website: <https://cybercrime.gov.in>

Helpline: 1930

REPORT WRITING

While researching cybercrime, I was surprised by how easily people fall victim to online fraud, especially UPI scams. Many users unknowingly share sensitive details such as OTPs or approve fake payment requests without verifying them. This shows a lack of awareness about digital safety.

This task helped me understand the importance of being cautious while using online payment systems. I have learned that even a small mistake can lead to financial loss. As a result, I will be more careful while making transactions and will never share my personal or banking details with anyone. This awareness will help me stay safe in the digital world.